EV tax proposal could cut into drivers' gas savings

Electric car owners would be forced to pay $250 annual fee for road projects. **In Money**

Kimberly Williams-Paisley on finding her voice on TV

"Farmer Wants a Wife" host chats about career and prepping for "9-1-1: Nashville." **In Life**

ILLUSTRATION BY EMILY NIZZI/USA TODAY NETWORK

USA TODAY

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Pressure building in airport impasse

ICE officers on patrol gather at Newark Liberty International Airport in New Jersey. The officers were sent to help relieve airport security staff shortages brought by a Homeland Security funding lapse. JULIAN LESHAY GUADALUPE/USA TODAY NETWORK

Demonstrators rally against ICE patrols at Atlanta Hartsfield-Jackson International Airport, among the airports hit hardest by security delays. MEGAN VARNER/GETTY IMAGES

ICE officers on duty as funding showdown hits critical juncture

Zachary Schermele, Thao Nguyen and Jeanine Santucci
USA TODAY

As Immigration and Customs Enforcement officers deployed to ease security lines at airports across the country, the pressure on the White House and Capitol Hill to end the monthlong shutdown of the Department of Homeland Security reached its highest point yet.

As of early March 24, however, President Donald Trump hadn't yielded. Instead, he upended sensitive negotiations among lawmakers over the weekend, bucking Senate Republicans and aides by tying the shutdown fight to a voter ID bill, the SAVE America Act, that has little chance of surviving Congress.

The dashed hopes of a nascent shutdown offramp came at a crucial juncture as the nation's airports reached a virtually untenable tipping point. TSA agents will go yet another week

See AIRPORTS, Page 2A

Senate confirms Mullin to lead DHS

Two Democrats join Republicans to approve Noem's replacement. **2A**

Taliban releases American held for over a year

Colorado researcher Dennis Coyle is on his way home after being held captive for more than a year by the Taliban in Afghanistan, U.S. officials confirm. Coyle was detained in January 2025 while conducting research on Afghan languages.

Full story, 4A

Deepfake porn left this town reeling

Schools, laws, awareness lag behind AI evolution

Alyssa Goldberg
USA TODAY

LANCASTER, PA – It's hard to describe the city of Lancaster as anything other than quaint. Its vibrant but small downtown is peppered with coffee shops, bookstores and friendly locals. It has charm in abundance. The same can be said for the upscale Lancaster Country Day School, a K-12 private school in the area that hosts just over 600 kids. They frolic around in matching uniforms and play on crisp green grass once school lets out.

Perhaps that's why the AI-generated sexual abuse scandal that recently rocked this town came as such a shock. No one saw it coming.

Only that's not exactly true. Students did.

One student, in particular, was sent a pornographic deepfake of his upper school classmate on the communications app Discord, apparently in error. He deleted the photo, left the group chat, and filed an anonymous report to a state-run tip line, which in turn reported it to the school. But the school failed to act, according to lawyers representing at least 10 families.

Over the next six months, two boys at the school continued to make AI-generated content of other girls.

The deepfakes came to light in May 2024 when the school received additional information and filed a ChildLine report with the state, but a criminal investigation began only after parents notified law enforcement, according to an investigation by the Lancaster County District Attorney's Office.

It was revealed that the two juvenile

See DEEPFAKES, Page 4A

Red state Dem Beau Bayh puts political dynasty to the test

"There was always a sense in my family of some obligation to give back to the community, and I knew whatever I was going to do in my life, it was going to take that path."

Beau Bayh
Democratic candidate for Indiana secretary of state

Beau Bayh, an attorney at MacGill PC, is running for the office that started his father's 25 years in public service. KELLY WILKINSON/USA TODAY NETWORK

Ex-senator's son seeks his first statewide office

Jay Stahl
USA TODAY

Kentucky Gov. Andy Beshear sat across from Beau Bayh in tan cushioned chairs on a January episode of the "Andy Beshear Podcast" filmed in Louisville.

The sons of respected former Democratic governors in bordering ruby-red states both donned dark blazers, dressing up the dull with colorful button-down shirts. Beshear wore pale pink. Bayh, who is running for Indiana secretary of state, wore baby blue.

"Congratulations!" Beshear proclaimed, praising Bayh for raking in $1.8 million in a recent fundraising haul,

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